International Scientific Conference

‘Agrifood, Biotech and AI, 2026’

Towards Inclusive, Resilient and Sustainable Agrifood Systems

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Introduction

Scientiae Naturalis Partner Consortium organize for the 5th year the International Scientific Conference '**Agrifood, Biotech & AI'.** Agrifood, Biotech and AI Armed conflicts across the Middle East, Sudan, Ukraine and beyond have driven some of the worst food crises in recent memory. We bring together startups, researchers, students and policymakers to explore how climate-adaptive crops and low-tech biotech can rebuild disrupted supply chains.

Scientiae Naturalis Partner Consortium **act as a** High-Stakes Knowledge Arbitrage Advisor **between academia, industry and policymaking. Scientiae Naturalis is a registered ROR partner in the global community for researchers and funding organizations and operates at the intersection of Health, Biotechnology, Food Systems, Environment, and Education — translating complex scientific realities into the language of institutional decision-making.**

Scientiae Naturalis Partner Consortium **participate actively in the European Climate Pact, and also contribute with White Papers in World Bank Initiatives and European Commission reforms.**

Conference Objectives

The conference serves as a Pay-for-Impact platform. It is the biggest Scientific and Citizens Consultation in Climate Change and Agrifood. We don't base our professional portfolio on IA, we index the scientific activity. The conference will act a s Data-Driven Lobbying platform, a Scientific Lobbying for EU, where researchers and startups with their data participate in the Report of Consultation and White Paper for the EU DG AGRI and EU DG CLIMA. The conference welcomes startups, researchers, students and policymakers to explore how climate-adaptive crops and low-tech biotech can rebuild disrupted supply chains.

Participation and Guidelines

The Conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** is organized by **Scientiae Naturalis partner consortium** and is a satellite event of **European Climate Pact**. The conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** is ORCID Compliant and Research Integrated

As such the conference is designed as fully ORCID enabled scholarity object:

- Every contribution has a DOI
- Every contributor has an ORCID
- Every relationship is machine readable.

The Conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** behaves like a node in the global research knowledge graph. The Conference is 'Diamond Open Access'. The Conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** shares Zero tolerance for Spam and Harassment and is also GDPR compliant and CCPA compliant. The Conference management team will update the applicant ORCID with the Edited Conference Proceedings. (The conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** Book of Proceedings will have a separate DOI).

Every Participant will have a personal digital badge. You share with us a video and your ORCID and we will take care of your academic visibility. Scientiae Naturalis Consortium will share with every participant a visibility report where their contribution is linked with their ORCID account and may appear in Google Scholar.

The Conference **'Agrifood, Biotech & AI 2026'** is a data producing node for the European Union Agri Initiatives, a strategic dissemination node for CAP and World Bank initiatives, transforming it in a strategic policy-informing platform.

Contributions may influence CAP simplification, eco-schemes, or climate-smart agriculture funding. Contributions may be part of a recognized policy-linked node, enhancing their credibility and opening doors to advisory roles. PhD students by presenting posters or videos ensures their research is seen by policymakers, funders, and international institutions, not just academics.

The participants work may contribute to CAP reforms (eco-schemes, digitalization, food security) and World Bank initiatives (CSA, irrigation, rural alliances). This positions you as a researcher whose findings matter beyond academia.

Proposal submission process

Overall process

The submission will be done through the official Conference Email Addresses. Only applications received directly through the Official Conference Email Addresses will be considered eligible. If the applicant discovers an error in a submitted application or aims to improve the application, the applicant may submit a new version provided the call deadline has not passed.

In order to facilitate this step, the applicant must get in touch with the managers of the open call at **scientiae-naturalis-registration@yahoo.com** requesting to resend the application until the deadline. Please be aware that once opened, the applicants should submit the completed application again before the set deadline or it will not be evaluated. Once resubmitted, only the last version received before the call deadline will be considered for evaluation.

Failure to resubmit will result in the presentation not being evaluated. Resubmission requests will be answered up to two hours before the deadline. The helpdesk cannot guarantee a timely response during the last two hours of the open call. Consider this when writing your presentations.

Scientiae Naturalis offers a dedicated support channel available for applicants at **scientiae-naturalis-helpdesk@yahoo.com**.

Requests will receive a response within 2 working days. While all possible effort will be made to respond in a timely manner, the teams should plan their submission accordingly, allowing enough time before the deadline (i.e., at least 2 working days) if they expect an answer.

Please note that any email received outside the designated support channel will not be taken into account. It is imperative that all requests or inquiries related to the submission procedures or the call itself are directed through the official support channel. Requests or inquiries received AFTER two days before the closure time of the call will neither be considered nor answered. Lack of receipt of an answer to an inquiry shall not constitute grounds for an extension or re-evaluation of a presentation.

Application preparation

For the successful submission, applicants are strongly advised to follow these steps:

- Check the guidelines for applicants to determine if your organization is eligible for the programme.
- Applicants are required to apply using the conference email address.
- Moreover, applicants must submit all the requested documents established in the call. The lack of any of the documents or answers to required questions will hinder the submission of the proposal.
- Be concrete and concise. Open questions have character limitations. Please examine all the open call documents
- Only submissions within the Open Call duration will be accepted. There will not be any deadline extensions unless there is a Force Majeure situation i.e., a major problem with the platform caused by the Scientiae Naturalis consortium and not by the applicants, making the system unavailable for a long period. It is strongly advised not to wait until the last moment to submit

Rules and Conditions of Presentations

Here are the key definitions that guide the selection of beneficiaries:

- Established country: the applicant must be established in a EU Member State or Horizon Europe Associated Country*.
    - *List of Horizon Europe Associated Countries as published by the European Commission on the date of the deadline of the call.
- Early-stage start-up:
    - The legal entity should be established at least six months prior to the deadline of the call. The 'start-up' should be compliant with the definition of SME, according to the EU definition of SMEs according to the EU recommendation 2003/361
    - Early-stage refers to the phase of start-up development generally preceding the rapid growth phase.

- Important Notes:
  - Scientiae Naturalis supports women in all their diversity. The word "woman" equates to a cis woman, or a transgender woman who is legally defined as a woman.
- Deep tech presentations: Deep tech innovation aims to provide concrete solutions to our societal problems by finding its source in a deep interaction with the most recent scientific and technological advances and by seeking to produce a profound impact in the targeted application areas. Sectors, which are most fertile for deep tech applications are life-science, computing, food and agri-tech, aerospace, energy and clean-tech, industrial technologies.
- Poster Presentation: In this form should be presented datasets, technical reports form or Methodologies [PhD students or Researchers].
- Abstract Presentation: 300-500 words. The candidate should use the Abstract form of the Conference.
- Language
  - English, French and Spanish are the official languages for the Conference open calls. Submissions done in any language other than English, French or Spanish will not be eligible or evaluated.
- Documents format
  - Any documentation requested in any of the phases of the open call and conference' implementation must be submitted electronically in pptx or Pdf format without restrictions for printing.
  - ***Absence of conflict of interest***
  - Applicants must not have any actual or potential conflicts of interest during the Conference selection process or the entire project duration. Any situations that could potentially influence the impartiality of the individuals taking part in the selection process, or during the project implementation, are considered conflicts of interest.
  - These can include financial interests, personal relationships, or any other factors that could affect the applicant's ability to remain impartial. All cases of conflict of interest will be assessed on a case-by-case basis by the relevant Scientiae Naturalis selection committee and consortium partners.

- If an applicant is found to have a conflict of interest, this could result in the application being disqualified. It is important to note that Scientiae Naturalis consortium partners, their affiliated entities, employees, and subcontractors are not allowed to submit a proposal and therefore to receive any financial support through the open calls, as this would violate the European Commission's regulations.

- Ethical Issues
  - Sceintiae Naturalis strictly adheres to the fundamental ethical principles outlined in the "European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity". To ensure compliance, all applicants are required to acknowledge and accept our privacy policy and declaration of honour during the submission process. This acknowledgment confirms that, by submitting the form, they accept the terms described in the provided text. No additional documents need to be uploaded; applicants are solely required to read and agree to the terms outlined when submitting the form.
  - During the submission process the ethics self-assessment questionnaire needs to be completed. During the evaluation process, the Scientia Naturalis consortium may verify whether the self-assessment declaration aligns with the contents of the application. In cases where clarification is needed, the consortium reserves the right to contact the applicant. If an applicant indicates that their application may have ethical issues, an ethics review will be conducted. Applications that fail to adequately address ethical concerns or privacy aspects will be rejected. All applicants must thoroughly review and assess their applications for any potential ethical issues before submission. Failure to comply with the ethical guidelines outlined in the "European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity" could lead to disqualification of the application. Therefore, it is of utmost importance that all applicants take the necessary steps to ensure that their proposals meet the highest ethical standards.

- Data Protection
  - Scientiae Naturalis requires access to Personal and Entity Data in order to process and evaluate applications. As open call coordinator, Scientia Naturalis will act as the Data

Controller for all data submitted through the Conference Email Address for this purpose. To ensure the safety and security of this data, the Scientiae Naturalis Conference platform has been designed and operates under strict compliance with The General Data Protection Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (GDPR). Therefore, all applicants are required to accept the Conference Platform terms to ensure full coverage.

Proposal Evaluation and Selection Process

Application reception

- Submissions will be done ONLY via the Official Conference Email, and it will be the unique entry point for all application submissions. Applications submitted by any other means will not be considered nor evaluated. Only the documentation included in the submission will be considered by evaluators.
- The application reception will close on **14/05/2026, 23.:59 CEST, Brussels time**. There will not be any deadline extensions unless there is a Force Majeure situation, caused by the Scientiae Naturalis consortium and not by the applicants, which renders the system unavailable.
- Evaluation process
- The evaluation process to be followed during the selection of the applicants is shown in the following figure. Before entering into the programme, a two-step evaluation will take place:
- The evaluation process will be evaluated according to the following categories:
- Eligibility criteria
- An automatic filtering to discard non-eligible proposals will follow the shortlist below.
- Eligibility criteria check will verify:
    - All the required fields in all documents uploaded
- are correctly completed.
- The organization is a ‘deep tech’ company.
- The candidate is a PhD student with ORCID active number, A researcher with ORCID active number or a practioner with ORCID active number.
- The uniqueness of the proposal: the proposal has been already funded in the EU or Horizon Initiatives or other Innovation initiative and/or any other fund.

- None of the co-founders or employees of the organization are currently working for any of the Scientiae Naturalis Consortium beneficiaries.

Experts' remote evaluation

The proposals that pass the eligibility check will move to the remote evaluation stage.

These applications will be assessed by two external and independent evaluators composing the evaluation panel: one with technical, and another one with commercial business background. The evaluation panel will be selected seeking geographical and gender balance. Their knowledge and expertise in the thematic areas of the proposal will be considered.

The selected evaluators will be independent of the organizations involved in the consortium and of any third party applying to the call. The evaluators will sign a declaration of confidentiality concerning the contents of the proposals they read. The evaluators will assess the proposals based on 3 different evaluation criteria (Impact, Excellence, and Implementation).

- Alignment of the application with the call;
- Degree of deep tech innovation i.e., going beyond the state-of-the-art, chances to succeed, its feasibility;
- IPR aspects.
- Implementation:
- An overall gender balance and the position held by women in the startup;
- Team's skills, motivation, and commitment to execute the project;
- Quality and efficiency of the work plan i.e., whether the proposed activities are sound and well explained, as well as whether these activities are TRL 4-TRL 6

The evaluators will score each award criterion on a scale from 0 to 5:

The total score will be calculated as the sum of the score of the 3 different criteria. The threshold for each criterion will be three (3), while the overall score threshold will be ten (10). That means if a proposal receives less than 3 in one criterion or less than 10 overall score, it will not be recommended for funding by the independent evaluators and will be automatically rejected.

Score normalization

The two evaluators will score the proposal differently without knowing the evaluation of their colleague, thus avoiding one evaluator conditioning the other. Therefore, the same evaluation may receive very different scores. The normalization step guarantees a more balanced distribution of scores and reduces the possibility of biases and distortions.

Presentation Forms and Documents to be submitted

The application process will be exclusively through the Conference email: **scientiae-naturalis-registration@yahoo.com**.
Before you begin, we recommend carefully reviewing Abstract Form, the Poster Presentation Guidelines and Annex I, to familiarize yourself with key elements. The presentation should be structured into sections designed to evaluate the impact, excellence, and implementation. External evaluators, experts in various related fields, will use these criteria to select the most promising proposals.

The poster presentation must be uploaded in pptx format through in the Conference email address. The three-minute video is recommended to upload it into a file-sharing platform or website e.g. Google Drive, Dropbox, YouTube, etc in private mode and copy the link to the video into the Abstract form.

Every Abstract form sent by the candidate (if startup) should have a Copy of the link to a 3-minute video of the (co-)founder pitching the company, its mission and vision, its technology and future plans.
Every Abstract form sent by the candidate if PhD, Researcher, or Practitioner should have the link of the 3-minute video of the applicant, that will present also the original work in the Abstract. (The three-minute video is compulsory to be uploaded into one of the platforms listed here: YouTube, Vimeo, Canva or Zoom recording and with settings on public or access anyone with the link.).

The Video presentation should be a Carousel Slider of the PhD researcher, as well as the presenting video of the Practitioner. After the evaluation, every accepted Video presentation in the Conference will be DOI registered and ORCID linked. It will appear to institutional profile of the applicant.

Video Quality Assurance Metrics

Legibility Test: Slides must be readable at 50% scale on a laptop screen. | Audio Check: Voice intelligibility >95% in automated speech recognition tests. | Perceptual Metrics: SSIM or VMAF scores above 80 indicate acceptable fidelity. |

Actionable Recommendations

Conference Presentation Recording: 1080p, 30 fps, 6 Mbps bitrate, AAC audio at 192 kbps. | Camera framing: speaker waist-up + slides visible. | Use lapel or condenser mic for clarity. | Delivery: Export in MP4 (H.264) for universal playback. | Provide adaptive streaming versions (low, medium, high quality).|

The application will have part of the Annex 1 the Ethics self-assessment:

- Ethical considerations for biological material and data handling.
- Clinical and non-clinical research ethics.
- International and environmental ethical concerns.

The Applicant in the Declaration of Honor should:

- Certifies accuracy, completeness, and compliance.
- Declares no administrative sanctions, exclusion situations, conflicts of interest or previous funding in the initiative.

Applicants must strictly adhere to the Abstract form provided by Scientiae Naturalis consortium, which defines sections and the overall length. Evaluators will be instructed not to consider extra material in the evaluation.

Guidelines for Poster Submission

The selected posters will be displayed on the Conference webpage and at the Conference Social Media Platforms during the poster session and at least 200 days after the Conference Ending. During all our previous symposia, the poster session was a great success and called the attention of many interested people. It is a fantastic opportunity to discuss your work with high level scientists and to have a substantial impact on policy-makers.

Please note that, due to strict **Scientiae Naturalis** communication regulations, all posters will need to go through the **Scientiae Naturalis** communication division for clearance before being uploaded on the official website.

For this reason, you are kindly requested to:

- Design your poster using the PowerPoint template for an A0 size. Each theme has its own specific template: Theme 1 | Theme 2 | Theme 3 | Theme 4.
- Poster sections: In almost all scientific posters you will find a title, author names and affiliations, introduction, methods, results, conclusions, and acknowledgements sections. Some other additions you might wish to include is a references section, for example.

- Please use the following specifications:
  - Titles - Verdana, size 80; Headings/subtitle - Verdana, size 45; Body text - Georgia, font size 32; Caption – Verdana, font size 22;
  - Participants may not submit any entries which include content generated by any generative **Artificial Intelligence (AI) tool**, including but not limited to photorealistic imagery, graphics or other artistic media.
  - Participants are allowed to use AI technology for ideation or editing purposes. Whenever a participant uses AI technology for these or any other purposes, they shall disclose how such technology was specifically used.
  - Should AI have been used in a way that is not compliant with these rules, **Scientiae Naturalis** reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to disqualify the entry from the competition.

Copyright and Privacy

Entrants must own the copyright of the material they submit to the 'Agrifood, Biotech & AI' Conference. If the material contains images of a person or persons, entrants must have obtained the permission and consent of those persons or their legal tutors for submitting the material.

The entrant declares that, to the best of his/her knowledge, no third party can claim any rights on the materials submitted.

Scientiae Naturalis will not seek additional approvals in connection with the use of the material and it will not be responsible for any claim or complaint alleging violation of the rights of third parties.

- Copyright of the material remains with the entrants. By entering the **ISC ''Agrifood, Biotech & AI' Conference**', entrants grant an irrevocable, perpetual, worldwide exclusive license to **Scientiae Naturalis**, to reproduce, distribute, display and create derivative works of the entries (along with a name credit) in connection with the contest and the promotion of **Scientiae Naturalis**'s work, in, amongst others:
  - **Scientiae Naturalis** corporate websites: www.**Scientiae Naturalis**.org corporate videos or digital recordings to illustrate the work of **Scientiae Naturalis**
  - printed **Scientiae Naturalis** publications, brochures or posters social media channels, including promotion of the contest itself any other media used by **Scientiae Naturalis** to communicate.

How can I take part?

- You are quite welcome to create a poster giving your answer to one of the topic of interest of '**Agrifood, Biotech & AI' Conference** to help others understanding your prospective and innovation in academia, industry or tech-market.
  - Physical submissions will not be accepted, acknowledged or returned under any circumstances.

- The call for participation will close at **23:59 (ICT) on May, 14 th 2026.**

- **Only one entry should be submitted per person**. Multiple entries from one person will result in disqualification.

- Poster entries may be also drawn, painted or sketched using pens, pencils, crayons or charcoal, or using oil, acrylic or watercolour paint, as well as mixed media. Digitally created artwork is also permitted. Poster entries must be based on a **PowerPoint template for an A0 size**. Each theme has its own specific template: Theme 1 | Theme 2 | Theme 3 | Theme 4. ·

- Participants **may not submit any entries which include content generated by any generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tool**, including but not limited to photorealistic imagery, graphics or other artistic media. Participants are allowed to use AI technology for ideation or editing purposes. Whenever a participant uses AI technology for these or any other purposes, they shall disclose how such technology was specifically used. Should AI have been used in a way that is not compliant with these rules, **Scientiae Naturalis** reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to disqualify the entry from the competition.

- Poster entries may or may not include text. If text is used, **no more than 550 words** can be accepted. Submissions will be accepted in French, English or Spanish only.
- **All artwork must be original and should not include logos or photographic images** of the Contestant or other personal information.
  - Posters can only be submitted using the Conference Email address provided below.
  - **Only digital files saved as a ppt/pptx** will be accepted and submissions must be made through the online form provided – please do not send in physical posters.

    - Use pictures (minimum 300 dpi/ppi resolution) and clear graphs/tables and insert images in their actual size;
    - Number all figures and tables. Please remember to place the captions for tables above the table and for figures below the figures (i.e. Fig.1: etc)
    - Please do not exceed 550 words.
    - Please consider the poster layout requirements:
    - It is important that your readers can navigate your poster and follow the logical progression of your work in an organized format. You are invited to choose a portrait format and to use a three-column style so that the reader will navigate the poster from column to column left-to-right.

- Make sure to leave clear borders around your columns, and good spacing between them so that they are easily distinguished. Deadline and follow-up
- Please submit your poster as **.ppt/.pptx** file at the latest on ***May 14th, 2026.***

ANNEX I - Criteria for the selection of the Participants:

a) Represent a range of geographical areas, ensuring gender and ethnic diversity;

b) Be willing to present original work or perspective;

c) Show availability and willingness to share globally the achievements;

d) Be able and eager to share knowledge with other practitioners and researchers and farmers;

e) Lead by example innovative thinking and experimentation from their own farming practices;

Conference Organizing Committee

December, 01, 2025